

Google continues to break language barrier

Google announces 'Instant Pages,' 'Instant' Image Search and 'Instant' Availability in 32 languages

ICANN approves new top-level domains

This could allow branded domains like .nvidia or generic ones like .automobile

LG Optimus 2X

Packs a hidden power punch

Straight out of the box, the LG Optimus looks just like any other smartphone out there. The 4.0-inch Gorilla Glass screen has four touch-based keys placed below it: menu, home, return and search. This one comes with Android 2.2, with a promised update for Android 2.3 soon. LG has made the UI look snazzier than before. The widgets look more in line of the HTC Sense, which is kind of the benchmark as far as Android UI's are concerned.

At the heart of the phone is the ARM Cortex A9 dual-core processor, clocking at 1 GHz. Switch on the 2X, and it's the quick boot speed that is the biggest indicator of a powerful phone. The interface loads quite quickly, and the

phone is actually usable without any lags.

Under standard usage scenarios, the Optimus 2X feels just as powerful as any single core 1GHz phone. However, get down to gaming and you'll feel the real difference. The load times are much less, the gameplay is smoother and feels a lot livelier. Download Asphalt 6: Adrenaline HD from the Android Market to get a first-hand experience of the dual-core power.

The camera performance is indeed very good. The 8MP snapper is capable of taking some really lively pictures, even in environments that are only moderately lit.

The brightness level of the



display is excellent. Usually with bright displays, colours go for a toss.

Its battery lasted two days with a mixture of usage scenarios - few calls, lots of IMs, some SMSes and a bit of web browsing.

It's surprising that the Optimus 2X feels like any other Android smartphone powered by a 1GHz single core processor; at least as far as basic usage patterns are considered. However, walk it down the gaming path, and that's when you'll notice that extra power. And that's what makes the real difference.

Visbal Mathur

Specifications

Screen: 4.0-inch display, Gorilla Glass, IPS LCD type; **Processor:** ARM Cortex A9 dual core @ 1 GHz, NVIDIA Tegra 2 chipset; **Resolution:** 480x800 pixel; **OS:** Android 2.2; **Storage:** 512 MB RAM, 8 GB built-in storage; **Expansion:** MicroSD card up to 32 GB; **Camera:** 8 MP, 1080p HD video recording, LED flash; **Battery:** 1500 mAh

Contact

LG India

Phone: 1800-1809999

Email: serviceindia@lge.com

Price: ₹26,990

7.5/10

Features 8.0
Performance 8.0
Build Quality 7.0
Value for Money 7.5

Specifications

Screen: 7 inch, Resistive, 480x800; **CPU:** 1GHz ARM Cortex; **RAM:** 512 MB; **Storage:** 8 GB; **Weight:** 400 g; **OS:** Android 2.2; **Ports:** miniHDMI, miniUSB, 3.5mm audio, microSD card slot.

Contact

Creative Technology

Email: vinayendra.singh@compuageindia.com

Web site: http://in.creative.com

Price: ₹17,999

6.0/10

Features 6.0
Performance 6.0
Build Quality 7.5
Value for Money 6.0

Creative Ziio 7-inch Tablet

Falls short of expectations

Encased in white plastic, the Ziio has a good-looking metallic sheen on the back. The petite tablet's build quality is nice too, and it weighs just 400 gms. The Ziio also bundles an HDMI port capable of 720p playback. But that's where the excitement ends.

The Creative Ziio has a resistive touch screen and the older Android 2.2 OS. Using the screen with your fingers is difficult with no multi-touch support. What's more, the Ziio doesn't support Android Market, cutting off access to a multitude of apps; the accompanying ZiiStore just isn't good enough. The Ziio does have a thoughtful dock at the bottom - just above the touch-sensitive

menu buttons strip - for quick launch of apps for music, video, photo and web browsing.

Reading is good on the Ziio's bright screen via the bundled ebook app. Audio from its onboard speakers was loud but of poor quality overall. We paired it with a pair of Creative T12 wireless speakers, after much difficulty. The tablet played HD 720p videos smoothly. Its front-facing 0.3 MP camera - specifically for video chats with a bundled app - did okay while clicking photos or shooting videos. Using the tablet outdoors under direct sunlight wasn't great. The tablet's battery lasted just



under two days on a single charge, while browsing the web over Wi-Fi, reading books and listening to music.

The Ziio is priced attractively, has a good processor and sizable 8GB of storage. But overall user experience on the Creative Ziio was okay at best, nothing to blow your mind away.

Jayesh Shinde